Brett Hicks

Art Director

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Summary

Seasoned, multi-disciplinary Art Director leading brand and digital work at a Nashville studio with years creating brand, identity, and promotional work for national brands including Crunchyroll, Tractor Supply Co., Ryman Hospitality Properties, and Rite Aid. Directed concept development, design teams, and creative execution across 250+ client websites and campaigns, specializing in employer brand systems and recruitment platforms serving workforces of 50,000+. Experienced leading and mentoring design teams, presenting creative direction to enterprise stakeholders, and building brand systems that remain in service for years after launch.

Skills

Art Direction | Adobe Creative Suite | Photoshop | Illustrator | InDesign | Figma | Typography | Layout | Illustration | Brand and Identity Systems | Brand Guidelines and Style Guides | Design Systems | Campaign and Promotional Design | Information Architecture | UI/UX | Web Accessibility (WCAG AA) | Responsive Design | Microsoft Office | PowerPoint | Motion and Animation | Storyboarding | Stakeholder Presentation | Design Mentorship | Creative Team Collaboration | Claude Design | AI-Assisted Design and Development Workflow | AI Workflow Standards and Review | AI Content and Research Support

HTML | CSS | JavaScript | React | TypeScript | Next.js | TailwindCSS | Cross-Functional Collaboration

Selected Projects

- **Rite Aid Careers:** employer brand system spanning **4 brands, 17 states, 2,400+ locations** (2022 — 2024)
- **TSC Careers:** recruitment platform scaled through **23% store growth to 2,000+ Tractor Supply stores** (2017 — 2023)
- **TSC Benefits:** internal benefits platform **serving 54,000 team members**, in **continuous service 8+ years** (2018 — present)
- **Ryman Careers:** employer identity unifying **9 cultural entertainment brands** (2018 — 2022)

Experience

Art Director

Brett Hicks Design | Nashville, TN **Feb 2025 — Present**

- Directed brand and web design for clients across music, retail, and professional services, handling engagements end to end from strategy and design through build and ongoing maintenance.
- Used AI-assisted design tooling, including Claude Design, to produce interface elements and layout components across client and personal builds, shortening the path from concept to working front-end.
- Continued as design partner on Tractor Supply's internal benefits platform, delivering interface updates and digital assets supporting communication to **54,000+ team members**.
- Restructured and redesigned the website for Sera Business Advisors, a business consulting and corporate training firm, reorganizing a multi-service offering into a clear information architecture and providing continued design support.
- Designed album artwork, iconography, and logo work for Nashville recording artist N. Justice across multiple releases, with covers appearing on projects that have accumulated **500,000+ combined streams**.
- Advised recording artist N. Justice on AI guardrails for visual and brand work, defining where generative tools fit the process and where original artwork and human authorship stayed non-negotiable.

Art Director

Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN **June 2015 — Feb 2025**

- Directed design and front-end delivery for **250+ client websites and web apps**, including national work for Tractor Supply Co., Ryman Hospitality Properties, Rite Aid, and Crunchyroll.
- Led art direction on enterprise recruitment and employer brand platforms serving workforces of up to **54,000 team members across 49 states**, translating business hiring problems into information architecture, visual systems, and shipped interfaces.

- Directed and mentored designers on a rotating basis across concurrent client accounts, reviewing creative work and setting visual craft standards, while collaborating with a creative director, copywriter, and full-stack developer to deliver campaigns end to end.
- Built and maintained design systems that outlasted their launches: one recruitment platform absorbed 23% company growth across six years without a redesign, and an internal benefits platform has run continuously for eight years and eight open enrollment cycles.
- Established brand architecture allowing multiple subsidiary brands to retain distinct identity while reading as a single employer, across portfolios of up to **9 consumer brands**.
- Directed accessibility and performance standards as design constraints rather than post-production fixes, targeting WCAG AA and low-bandwidth mobile conditions from the first comp forward.
- Presented creative direction to enterprise stakeholders across HR, recruiting, and marketing, aligning competing internal audiences on a single approach.
- Managed concurrent delivery across multiple active client accounts, owning scope, timeline, and creative quality.
- Progressively modernized studio practice from static HTML and CSS through responsive design, component systems, and Git-based workflow, moving live client platforms forward without disruptive rebuilds.

Senior Web Designer
Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN **June 2013 — June 2015**

- Mentored interns and junior designers on design and front-end development, reviewing work and providing creative feedback
- Illustrated character art and assets for numerous games for web and mobile platforms
- Designed and wrote the front-end for the Tractor Supply Community Marketing Toolkit, a planning application **serving 2,300+ stores** that supports **1,200+ county fair sponsorships annually and remains in use today**.
- Designed digital and promotional material for Dumor Champion's Club such as site design and front-end, coupon design
- Managed multiple projects simultaneously, collaborating with my Creative Director to establish proper time frames and deadlines for various steps for each project. This ensured proper time management and was key to eliminating dead time waiting on client responses, and staying on track to meet every deadline.

Web Designer
Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN **May 2010 — June 2013**

- Designed product and marketing sites, as well as web applications for clients such as: Monterey Boats, Red Kap, Tennessee Bank & Trust, Tractor Supply Co., and the City of Nashville just to name a few
- Designed the Logo and Branding of ContestApps **winning an AIGA Case award**.
- Designed and built the front end for the Walk100 for the city of Nashville, which **recorded over 6,000 users and logged over 105,000 miles walked by Nashvillians**. The initiative was covered by all of the major media outlets in the city. Not only was the program successful, it has been duplicated by other cities as well on top of **winning an AIGA Case Award**.
- Storyboarded and animated character-driven interactive work, including games and presentation pieces, handling motion design from board through final asset delivery.
- Designed and wrote code for email campaign creation for TSC 4-H & FFA, Titan Management Group
- Collaborated with designers and copywriters of our design partner Locomotion Creative

Awards

Nashville AIGA Case Award Branding Design “ContestApps” — 2011

Nashville AIGA Case Award Site Design “Walk100” — 2011

Addy, Professional Gold “Porte Italia” website — 2018

Education

Middle Tennessee State University - BFA, Graphic Design / Web Design 2010

Codecademy - Professional Certificate, Front-End Engineer 2025

Codecademy - Professional Certificate, Full-Stack Engineer 2026